

The never-ending fight over Jerusalem: what is the real reason

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Being overly blessed to be remembered as a significant part in the history of creation and establishment of three major religions followed all around the world; could the ancient city of Jerusalem maintain the integrity of peace and shelter that the simplest idea of religion promises? Ever could the walled city full of sacred architecture assure the minimum physical security that even a simple mosque in an alleyway of a third world country can?

No, instead life there bears risk no less than living between a crossfire.

The country that resides Jerusalem, Palestine, used to be part of the great British Empire. After the World War II, while the world focused mostly on the racial apartheid developed and exercised in the South African region, no one noticed the emerging instability within Palestine and the urge of the Jewish nationalism to take over the land in whole, which, however, is recorded with equal importance in the history of Christianity and Islam. Since the Jewish splitted with their part of lands, making Israel the only Judaism core country, leaving Palestine scattered, divided and powerless, religious apartheidism saw its extreme.

Nowadays, the whole region which used to be Palestinian is mostly Israel with a struggling part of Muslim fighting hard to keep their position held geographically upon a place so significant to their religion. To approach in terms of ethnic identity, groups of people sharing the same belief, values, customs and norms as they come from a common background (Kottak, 2014), the old city of Jerusalem is the history bearer of four such, namely Armenian, Jewish, Christians and

Muslims. In terms of religion, the grouping goes down to three as Armenians are Christian. For them, the St James Church residing in the old city of Jerusalem contains and maintains Armenian civilization and culture (BBC News, 2014).

For the Christian, it is the Church of the Holy Sepulchre Jesus was crucified. It is believed that the crucifixion occurred on the Golgotha or the hill of Calvary and that the empty tomb of His is inside the sepulchre, which is also the site of his resurrection (BBC News, 2014).

The Muslim Quarter is the largest and contains the Dome of Rock and the al-Aqsa Mosque which is known to Muslims as Haram al-Sharif. The mosque is known to be the third holiest site in Islam. It is believed that Prophet Muhammad (SA) travelled here from Mecca during his night journey and prayed with the souls of all the prophets. Whereas, the Dome of the Rock holds the foundation stone, where it is believed that Prophet Muhammad (SA) then ascended to heaven (BBC News, 2014).

The Jewish believe the Western Wall to be the remains of the retaining wall of the mount on which the Holy Temple once stood. There the Holy of Holies, the most sacred site in Judaism, was located. They also believe that the foundation stone of the world was located here and that the Dome of the Rock is the site of the Holy of Holies (BBC News, 2014). This is the cause of all wars and apartheidism.

Where to an open eye, or to someone who has complete faith upon the holy religious books and all the prophets bringing them to Earth, connection of all these religions to that same place should be normal; the Jewish remain unturned on their belief. Following the formation of

independent Israel, their lone mission had been to gain complete control over Jerusalem for a structure that does not even exist for real.

In a country, the classification of what used to be upon ethnic identity before for Israel, it is now abruptly upon religion. Once the Jewish got their platform and power, they did not hesitate to exercise it. Winning back to back wars with the Arabs and Egypt gave a boost. And overtime, they captured over the whole land of what used to be a Muslim ruled state. Palestine kept getting constricted and now barely exists.

Yet the first world nations struggle to declare Israel as an apartheid state. Since when did the Jewish country Israel started having complete control over Jerusalem that they dared to declare such a holy place as their country's capital? Does anyone remember the UN peace treaty where the city was agreed to be shared upon by both countries? And now that they imposed control, with the applauding support from leading countries all around the world, the Israel government misses no chance to torture the Muslims within the Palestine boundery in over to erase their existence.

Is it not apartheidism? What else is it then? Why would such a holy place be fought upon politically?

Where there is God, it is serene, peaceful; not life threatening. If the Jewish party really wanted it from religious sentiment, they would have made it look like a sacred place; where it might have been petals floating in the air, not missiles. Holy places come with an assurance of shelter to all humankind, regardless of race and caste. But, here greed made the system such that the caste every individual belongs to decide the fate of his life.

For whatever reason placed fourth, claiming power and authority and power over Jerusalem is not justified. What the apartheid Israel and their fellow supporters never understood is that the city is too powerful to take control over, to be held captive. So, instead of killing millions of innocent lives fighting over it, humanity should seek peace from such a pure and sacred place.

Reference:

1. BBC News. (2014, October 30). What makes Jerusalem so holy? *BBC News*.
<https://www.bbc.com/news/world-middle-east-26934435>
2. Kottak, C. (2014). *Cultural Anthropology* (16th ed.). McGraw-Hill Education.